

Deck review notes

Reviewed Team Cultural Blend – UNSW Hackathon 2026.pdf (14 pages, exported from Google Slides, 2026-09-03 17:03) against the verified numbers in reports/generated_full_dataset/ and docs/1_data_dictionary.md.

The design is strong and the numbers are almost all right. Every statistic I could check reproduces: the correlations (0.429 / 0.285 / 0.058 / 0.019 / 0.010), the regional means (3.7 to 15.6 days), the topic range (1.5 to 13.5 days), the classifier metrics (AUC 0.8997, AP 0.8301, Brier 0.1156, $87,466 + 191,421 = 278,887$), and the few-cluster p-values (ME 0.12 / 0.21 / 0.08, CA 0.06 / 0.14 / 0.07). Slide numbering below uses the PDF page, with the deck's own step number in brackets.

1. Fix before presenting — these are wrong, not just awkward

p4 [03] · "Borrowers now wait longer for capital" and the headline "A slower market where longer borrowers wait is the operating reality."

96.4% of loans are disbursed to the borrower before the page goes live, a median of 24 days earlier. The borrower is not waiting — the field partner's capital is. This is the one thing on the deck that a judge could use to say we misunderstood the platform, and it is armed in Q&A D6. The headline is also ungrammatical ("where longer borrowers wait").

Suggested: "A slower market is the operating reality — and it is partner capital that waits."

p5 [04] · "region shows similarly large gaps"

Not true, and it is the one direction the claim can't go. Region spans 3.7 to 15.6 days — about 4× — which is the narrowest structural field, because grouping countries into regions compresses country's 100× spread. Sector spans 13×. Country spans 0.2 (Nepal) to 20.5 (Senegal).

Suggested: "country spreads are wider still — 0.2 to 20.5 days." That strengthens the slide instead of weakening it.

p6 [05] · Headline "Storytelling coaching won't move the needle."

This asserts no effect. Everything we've defended for thirteen review rounds says the opposite discipline: absence of robust evidence is not evidence of absence. It is written into Q&A A1's trap line and into the limitations slide. If a judge quotes this headline back, the honest answer contradicts our own slide.

Suggested: "We can't find robust evidence that coaching moves the needle." The yellow sub-line underneath it is already exactly right — it just needs to be the claim, not the footnote.

p9 [07] · Borrower table, "Profile: Female can represent household to submit loans"

This tells households to put the woman forward to get funded faster. Three problems, any one of which is enough:

- It is an association, not a cause — our own limitations slide (p10) says no borrower was randomly assigned anything, and the gender gap is unexplained (Q&A E2).

- It advises **gaming a demographic field**, which is not something the evidence supports and not something a judge will read kindly.
- It contradicts the position we take everywhere else, that the gender gap is a **structural gap for Kiva to investigate**, not a tactic for borrowers.

Suggested: cut the row, or move the finding to the platform side — "the 2.3 vs 7.7 day gap is a structural gap for Kiva to explain, not advice for borrowers."

p9 [07] · "Sector: Clothing, Transportation, Services, Construction, Agriculture & Retail"

If this reads as recommended sectors, it points at the wrong end: **Clothing is the slowest sector in the data at 12.1 days**, against Sanitation at **0.9**. A borrower also can't pick a sector — it follows from what the loan is for.

p9 [07] · "Focus on Loan Amount Range & Repayment terms: Top 1 & 2 strongest correlation"

Reads as "ask for less". We explicitly decline to give that advice (Q&A A4) because the association is confounded with what borrowers need the money for. Either state the honest version — a bigger ask sits on the platform longer, which is a partner planning fact — or cut it.

2. Worth changing if there's time

- p4 [03] · "46% >> 30% >> 30%" — the two 30%s hide the actual finding. The exact shares are 46.0% / 30.3% / 30.0%: the "recovery" is **minus 0.3 points**. Showing 46% → 30.3% → 30.0% makes the point the bullet is already making. (The >> glyph also reads as "much greater than" in a statistics room.)
- p5 [04] · Figure 3 shows its title twice — once as the slide's bold caption, once baked into the chart image.
- p8 / p9 · both slides show step 07 in the progress rail.
- Appendix labels run A1, A2, A4 — there is no A3. Nothing is missing: our A3 was the correlation detail, and its chart was promoted onto p5. Just relabel.
- p1 · "University of Technology Sydney" — worth a deliberate check that this is the affiliation we want on a UNSW-run competition. Fine if it's accurate; just make it a decision rather than a leftover.
- p1 · the "1.45 million real loans" line is gone from the title slide, though the script still says it aloud.
- p8 [07] · no borrower item and no capital-cycle point. Both now live only in the spoken script and in Q&A D6. With p9 existing as a separate borrower slide, the two should agree.

3. Typos

Page	Reads	Should read
p2 [01]	"they posted ?"	"they posted?"
p3 [02]	"Most significant results results did NOT survive ."	"Most significant results did not survive."
p3 [02]	"a stricter few cluster reference"	"a stricter few-cluster reference"
p4 [03]	"Since 2020: under a third, and after 4 years though not yet recovered."	"Since 2020: under a third — and four years on, still not recovered."
p5 [04]	"Structural loan factors beats storytelling by a magnitude"	"Structural loan factors beat storytelling by an order of magnitude"
p5 [04]	"Female vs male-posted loans median funding speed are 2.3 vs 7.7 days"	"Loans posted by women fund in a median 2.3 days; by men, 7.7"
p8 [07]	"for Kiva team"	"for the Kiva team"
p10 [08]	"Association, never causation .No borrower was..."	"Association, never causation. No borrower was..."

4. What is right and should not be touched

- The chronological train/test exhibit and its note — this is the slide that earns the method credibility.
- The within-region slope table on p6, including the norm-ref only verdicts and the $t(1) = 12.7$ note. That table is the honest core of the whole deck.
- The A1 appendix — pooled category sizes, the "single country, not estimable" row for North America, and "the screen can downgrade a claim, never certify one".
- The A2 SHAP framing: "complementary predictive evidence only — it cannot confirm or refute a coefficient."
- The A4 classifier boundary: "retrospective ranking prototype among eventual funders", not an early-warning system.
- The closing quote.